



CSS syntax 30m

Syntax in web development refers to the spelling and grammar of a computing language. The CSS syntax defines how CSS rules should be structured. A CSS ruleset consists of a selector and a declaration block.

- The selector specifies the HTML element to be styled.
- The declaration block defines how the web browser should style the specified HTML element.

Example 6.2 shows the syntax structure of a CSS declaration block. Hover over each box to see the explanations.



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HTML

CSS

Result

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LIVE

```

.container {
  display: flex;
  align-items: center;
  margin: 20px;
  white-space: nowrap;
}

.box {
  background-color: #3B84C4;
  color: white;
  padding: 10px;
  margin: 2px;
  text-align: center;
  position: relative;
}

.box:hover::after {
  content: attr(data-label);
  position: absolute;
  top: 50px;
  left: 50%;
  transform: translateX(-50%);
  background-color: #fff;
  color: #333;
  padding: 5px;
  border-radius: 5px;
  white-space: nowrap;
}

```

Resources

1x 0.5x 0.25x

Rerun

Example 6.2 Syntax structure of CSS declaration block



A CSS ruleset consists of a selector, declaration, declaration block, property and property value.

Item	Definition
Selector	Defines the HTML element to which the style will be applied

Declaration block	Consists of a set of declarations separated by a colon (;); each declaration block is enclosed in curly braces ({ })
Declaration	Each declaration is made up of a property and a value separated by a colon (;)
Property	Defines the style that will be applied to the element. The style could be related to font colour, background colour or border colour.
Value	Defines the specific values of the style that is to be applied. This is where you'd define the specific colour to be applied or the specific font size.

Dig deeper

CSS has a wide range of properties and values for modifying styles. Explore the many ways CSS can be used to change the appearance and layout by reading *W3Schools' Full Reference List of CSS Properties*.

Let's now return to the HTML code that is used to create the Open Polytechnic's web page for BIT703 Web Technologies.

Can you see that we've styled the heading 'Web Technologies – BIT703' using CSS in Example 6.3? Can you identify the selector, declarations, property and property values used?

Have a go at editing the CSS code. See if you can change the style used on the heading.



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HTML

CSS

Result

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```
h1 {  
  color: black;  
  font-size: 50px;  
  text-decoration: underline;  
  background-color: silver;  
}
```

Resources1x0.5x0.25xRerun

Example 6.3 CSS ruleset

☒ CSS ruleset

Non-Assessed

Status: Done
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Reset ↺

```
h1 {  
    color: dark grey;  
    text-align: center;  
}
```

From the CSS ruleset given above, identify the following:

1. What is the selector?
2. How many declarations are there?
3. What are the properties?
4. What are the values?
5. What style will be applied with this CSS ruleset?

h1

none

color, text-align

dark-grey, center

the text colour for h1 will be grey, and the text will be centered within the space it occupies

25 / 100 Word Limit

1. The selector is h1 (that is the first heading).
2. There are two declarations used in this example, each written as property:value.
3. The properties are color and text-align.
4. The values are dark grey and center.

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5. By using this CSS ruleset, the heading background will appear dark grey and the text will be centre-aligned.

Previous attempts ▼



Let's now explore CSS selectors a bit more.



Thoughts on this page?

